



District of the Nation of Papua New Guinea, although the people's culture and traditional ways are still valued. The islands are beautiful tropical paradises with bleached white sand, coconut palms, dugout

canoes, thatched fishing huts, and little or no traffic. Many of the islands don't even have electricity. The islanders are best known for their extraordinary method of exchange and trade with each other, known as the *Kula*.



TROBRIAND CRICKET

Cricket was introduced to the Trobriand Islands by Christian missionaries to discourage ritual warfare. The Islanders took to it with enormous enthusiasm and added many of their own rules. They perform special dances for every point they gain and have adapted some of the rules.

The yam houses stand in the centre of the village. More care goes into the building of these than of real houses.

YAM STORAGE

The yam is prized in the Trobriand Islands. It grows well in the thin soil and is a staple food. The islanders build elaborate and beautiful yam houses to store and show off their prized vegetables, which sometimes grow to over 3 ft (1m).



THE YAM FESTIVAL

Yams are more than just a food, they represent wealth and are a symbol of life. During the annual yam festival, which lasts over a month, the yams are picked and stored and the islanders hold dance competitions and cricket matches. Beauty, body ornamentation, and magic are all a large part of the festival.

SING-SING

Dance festivals, or *sing-sings*, are an important part of Trobriand life. Often the men and women dance separately. The girls perform a seductive *cassava* dance, swaying their hips in short grass skirts and snaking their hands from side to side. The men, in contrast, stamp on the sand to the rhythmic sound of drums.

